

Interviewer: Okay, again, so I will officially start, so good evening, so of course some preliminaries, thank you again for participating in this interview and as mentioned over our email conversation, email correspondence. We want to know more about your views on romantic relationships and we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. So, we're now recording, so thank you. And then for the consent, you can also actually babalikan natin yung later ko ano yung mas gusto niyong option with respect to the sharing of the information. Kasi syempre, sometimes may preference na pero pag natapos yung interview baka mag-ibay yung preference. So we can reiterate that later ko ano yung preferred niyong option ng sharing.

Interviewer: So first question, first set actually ng questions or our own demographics. Ito yung mga, just some basic information about you. So how old are you if you don't mind me asking?

Speaker: [41-45].

Interviewer: [41-45].

Interviewer: And how long have you been together with your partner?

Interviewer: So, not necessarily na married, okay, so pwedeng if you were to count.

Speaker: Yari ka.

Speaker: [Year] kasi so, tama [Year].

Interviewer: [11-15] years.

Interviewer: [11-15] years, okay, thank you.

Interviewer: So and do you have children?

Speaker: Yes, [1-5] children.

Interviewer: Okay, and in your household, sino yung members in your, in regular members ng inyong household?

Speaker: It's my husband, myself and our two children. Kami lang.

Interviewer: Okay, right.

Interviewer: And in terms of income, what would you consider as your main source of income?

Speaker: I have a regular job.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Do I tell you my profession or?

Interviewer: Pwedeng general category if you like.

Interviewer: How would you?

Speaker: [Field].

Interviewer: So and if you would, there's like a position to your current job, how would you label that?

Speaker: I don't mind them sharing. I'm currently the [occupation]. So I handle all [occupation].

Interviewer: All right. And from here on kasi we will be asking about your relationship and your current partner or your husband. How would you like me to address your partner?

Speaker: Husband.

Interviewer: Husband, okay.

Interviewer: All right.

Interviewer: So now for a general idea about your current relationship, maybe not so much in detail, but can you tell me about your love story?

Speaker: Oh, we started out as friends. We were. college friends. And then stayed in touch when we both got our jobs na. He's one batch higher kasi than me. And then in [Year], we just parang reconnected and then went out. And then it started from there. Went out and then went out some more. We came closer and got together. So generally our love story.

Interviewer: But it started as friends, not really immediately as romantic or attractive. Maybe there's immediate attraction or something like that.

Speaker: Well, there was. But taken na. And then we just stayed friends. And then the opportunity came na we were both single. So we reconnected and then got close. And then ay, pwede pala develop. So it was a good opportunity to be together at that particular time. It was [Year].

Interviewer: I'm just taking down notes because I need to do a quick recap later.

Interviewer: Now, what else?

Interviewer: So how would you compare now? I'm moving on to another topic in the interview. It's the quality of the relationship.

Interviewer: How would you compare the quality of your relationship compared to that of your friends' relationships? So the quality of your relationship now compared to, let's say, your friends' relationships.

Speaker: Meaning compared to my friends and what their relationships are. Tama ba?

Interviewer: Yes. So in comparison to your current relationship. So the relationship quality of this relationship relative to the quality of the relationship of your friends, for example.

Speaker: Okay. I can say that our marriage, our relationship is stable. It has a strong foundation. I guess because I can attribute that to our friendship.

Speaker: Well, some of my friends right now are, they don't have the ideal quote-unquote ideal or that stable relationship with their spouse. So I guess I can say that our relationship has that good quality because first of all, it's based on friendship. So the trust is there ever since. And our way of communicating, it's healthy. It's constant. Of course, hindi ma-tatanggal yung mga...

Speaker: Once in a while, there are disappointments or frustrations, but I think that's normal. But nothing, no big fights. I don't think we really fight. We talk about it. So I guess maybe because I've known him for quite some time before we got married. It was easier to communicate, to say how I feel. He

understands ako yung mas moody kasi siguro dahil. Babae? Of course, especially when I got pregnant twice. Syempre iba yung hormones and all.

Speaker: He's very patient kasi may husband knows that. He's very patient and understanding. And I can even say, in a good way, selfless kasi siya. He would always put me in our children. I mean, top priority talaga. Dapat parang ganon. But I think what also keeps us, keeps our relationship healthy as well, is that he has his own thing. I have my own thing. It's important kasi na you're not together all the time. That you have time for yourself, your friends. Now, this is one of his best friends.

Speaker: So isang bituka lang yung mga yan. Mababait na tao talaga sila. And they and he has his own hobbies. He does things for himself. Because he has his own identity as well. We are known as [Name] and [Name]. But he also is [Name]. I am also [Name]. So I think that's for couples. Especially, we're both in the academe. Importante yung you have your own identity as well.

Speaker: Kasi, sorry, I have to bring this up. Because people cannot sleep without talking about [Name].

Interviewer: Oh yes, of course.

Speaker: What I mean is, I'm not saying we're the same. But what I'm saying is we're the same, I am my own person. He is his own person. We do great things together. Parang we contribute to society. Because we are teachers. We teach our children this and that. So our marriage, our relationship is built on a very strong foundation. Not just friendship. There's trust, there's love, there's open communication. And I can name, I can go on and on, [Name].

Speaker: Those are the essentials that I think we have. I'm not saying we're perfect and ideal. Because there's no such thing. But I think I am blessed to have a husband who has all that. And who complements what I have as a person. So I hope I was able to articulate it well. Basically, those are the things that set our relationship apart. That set our relationship apart from my friends.

Interviewer: There are actually some probe questions or additional questions that might be aligned to what you're already sharing. So maybe you can add more to that in a while. So thank you for that.

Interviewer: So I have my notes here. So maybe we can clarify later if there's something that I missed. Moving on to the next question. Let me put my paper there. Let me just check. I might have missed something. So in terms of relationship, so this time, aside from of course your husband, if it's okay with you, can I also ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker: The official one? De joke lang. I had [1-5]. [1-5] official ones that my family loved.

Interviewer: [1-5] before [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: Since high school.

Interviewer: So now the comparison is, since you've had [1-5] other relationships in the past, how would you compare the quality of your relationship now compared to your previous relationships? So something similar to the previous question, but this time the comparison is your other relationships.

Speaker: Well, the first one, kasi it's high school pa ako noon. So my maturity level, well it's not that high yet. But friend ko rin yun. But I guess comparing, I can compare the character of [Partner's Name] compared to them. Iba-iba kasi yung ugali nung mga yun.

Speaker: Ano sila? Hindi naman opposite ni [Partner's Name], but I was the independent one in the relationship. They were dependent on me. I'm not saying now I'm dependent on [Partner's Name] because I am a very independent person. So I met someone who is as independent like me. And that's [Partner's Name]. Sila, they were very dependent on me. Emotionally. Parang, ano ko na lang to sa akin, I mean that's my interpretation of it now that they relied on me.

Speaker: Hindi naman sa ako yung nagdadala ng relationship, pero parang mabigat kasi parang, teka lang, you're supposed to discuss this with me, you're supposed to decide together, pero they're not mature. Ang layon ng maturity ko sa kanila. The first one was in high school, high school to college. Yung dalawa naman working na ako. Pero ano eh, they were, I guess because they were younger than me, yung yung dalawa. But the first one is older than me. So I'm not sure if age has something to do with it. But our personalities, our characters, our values did not align.

Speaker: Kay [Partner's Name] aligned. aligned na aligned.

Interviewer: So just to be explicit about it, so if you were to compare the quality, because I think you've given me the substantial reasons why these relationships were actually different from your current relationship. But just to be explicit about it, if you say, if we're saying that we're comparing these relationships in terms of the quality, how would you know, let's say, if we focus on quality, would you know, I don't want to lead you into saying it. What I'm getting is it has better, the current relationship has better quality than these previous ones.

Interviewer: Is that correct to say?

Speaker: Definitely. I guess the part where I said that there's alignment kasi with our ugali, our values, what we believe in, the principles, it's aligned with my current one, with my husband. Yung sa kanila hindi, parang may misalignment. Kaya siguro, it didn't last at all because of that. I'm attributing it to that. Parang hindi kami MFE-O, hindi kami bagay. Parang ganon, hindi nag-match, hindi lang talaga kami match.

Interviewer: Okay. Now, we're still talking about quality, but in a general sense now, for this next question, for you, what makes a relationship high quality and maybe the mirror image of that is, what would make it low quality?

Interviewer: So maybe the first question first, which is, what do you think would make it high quality?

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Like, not just for your current relationship, but maybe just a general perspective of what makes a relationship high quality.

Speaker: Um, well, this is what I've learned in the past [11-15] years, [11-15] years of marriage. Um, our relationship started right. Walang sabit, walang sablay. One was in a relationship, walang anak, walang, it was clean, it was right, it started right. So, I believe, it proceeded favorably. Kasi, um, we were both single. Um, siyempre, mahirap kung kunyari may anak, diba? Or, or dating married. So, ibig ko sabihin, we started, everything started out really just right. Um, both our families, um, uh, respect uh, at the relationship, day-day, yung in-laws niya, love ako, love siya ng family ko, well accepted. I have a very big clan. So, so, talagang in-interview siya ng lahat and love siya ng lahat, ganon. So, um, the, the, getting

the affirmation of the people you love, even my friends, not just family, but friends. Um, I think that what makes a relationship high quality kasi wala kang tinatago e.

Speaker: Ang hirap when you are living in, in fear, or, or, you're, you're hiding something, wala, wala tinatago. It's just, uh, it, it started right? And, a decade, I mean, more than a decade later, it's still okay. Uh, and I think a relationship should be healthy. Healthy in, in a way that there's communication. Um, uh, well, I, I am [Religion]. We're both [Religion]. So, it's also, um, driven or, or guided by faith. Uh, I think that, that's, uh, ano na yan, parang dagdag ko na yan as a [Religion], no? na, it's, uh, ang center ng home namin, ng marriage namin, it's really the Lord.

Speaker: For me parang, when that is, uh, present or when that is there, um, no matter what, uh, difficulties or, or challenges that we may face, may anchor to me, anchor namin. So, it makes the relationship more, uh, parang, um, more meaningful, stronger, and, um, pag yung isa, medyo nahihirapan, nalulungkot o may pinagdadaanan. Yung isa, ano lang, sasaluhin siya, may, may, tapos, we, we both lead each other to, to the Lord. Ganon, ganon yung, nakikita ko um, um, uh, that's how I define high quality.

Speaker: Low quality is everything opposite that I said. If it didn't start outright, Halimbawa, mistress ka, or something, or, or, or, or hindi mo matanggap na yung, yung, uh, partner mo, may anak na. Yung ganon, yung, everything opposite that I said.

Interviewer: Yung mga complicating factors.

Speakers: Yes, complicated. That's right. Or, if hindi siya tanggap ng family, or hindi siya tanggap ng friends, or, uh, everything, all the things that I said, na opposite. Um, you're driven by what, kunwari, vices, or whatever, hindi, hindi strong yung faith. So, it will crumble. For me, the relationship will crumble if you have nothing to anchor it on. And our anchor is our faith.

Speaker: Actually, for me nga, [Name] faith, hindi lang faith in God. Kasi, that's too, for me, that's too religious then. Ang anchor then is tapat, you have faith in yourself, na, yung, yung hindi kasi, yung, kasi, you really need self-care na yun e, especially na yung pandemic, no. So, faith, para sakin, maraming meaning yun, faith in the Lord, faith in yourself, faith in other people. So faith in, in your husband, na hindi, um, nandyan lang siya, pag when you need him. And you know that this will work out because, alam mo, he will lead you also to making things happen, making things right and ganon. So, mirror image nun, all the opposite things I said. That makes my relationship unhealthy.

Interviewer: Okay, so thank you, ayan. Medyo repetitive na, but among these things, if you were to choose perhaps, what would you consider as the most important things in the relationship? Of course, you've mentioned several, actually parang, sa notes ko parang, four major, four key points, like the align, it started right, affirmation of the people you love, when there's healthy communication and when the center of the relationship is the faith in the Lord. But of course, you also added faith, faith in yourself, as well as faith to your husband. So, if there's something else that you want to point out, are there other, what would you consider as the most important, perhaps ingredient in the, or the things in the relationship? Is there anything else? Or, you know.

Speaker: Basically, I think, yun na yun na. But among those that I have mentioned, which you have, itemized na, doc. It's really the faith, faith in the Lord. I think everything will follow. If you have, if you have faith in Him and you pray every day for the family, for the marriage, and not just, not just praying

na you ask, but you say thank you. Prayer kasi namin pamilya yun eh. We always say thank you every day for each other. So, that, that simple thing is for me, powerful na. Kasi that grounds you.

Speaker: For me, it grounds, it grounds me na parang, ah, okay. Okay. Hindi maganda yung araw ko, pero, okay, ang dyan naman si [Partner's Name], ang dyan yung mga bata. So, magpapasalamat, ay, salamat, walang may sakit. Nakauwi si [Partner's Name] ng maaga, ganoon. Kasi, he travels from [Location] to we live in [Location] or, he travels every day.

Interviewer: Ahhh.

Speaker: two hours yun. He drives. So, hindi biro rin yun, doc na you, you pray for him na. He goes, thank you for bringing him home safe last night. It's always part of our prayers. So, that's the most important ingredient. Everything else will follow. For me, everything will follow.

Interviewer: All right. Thank you.

Interviewer: All right. Now, I will now shift to another topic, but this time, on the conceptualization of love. So, parang slambook ang dating,

Interviewer: but for you, what is love?

Speaker: Ay, gusto ko yan..

Interviewer: For you, what is love?

Speaker: Wow. What is love? Okay, ano nga ba mga sagot ko dati nung grade school ako? So, I learned this in theology at theology ng college ako. Love is, it's not a feeling, it's not, I can tell you what it's not. For me, it's not a feeling, it's not a disposition, but it is a, for me, it's a decision. It's addition, it's a parang, I think the word decision is better than choice. It's a decision that people make.

Speaker: Kasi for me, it's a gift being given to you by God. So, it's something na the decisionan mo, parang I will commit to this, I will say yes to this. So, but love, it's, tama ba Doc?, it's in the context of marriage, you're asking in the context of marriage.

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: It's a decision you make in that it's pang forever. May forever, na niniwala ako doon. Kasi kailangan mo you have papanindigan mo na ahh okay may forever. Parang nakayanan mo sa Diyos at mabibigyan ka ng regalo tapos di ka papabaya no.

Speaker: So, for me, it's a decision. So, if you say yes, it's a decision of saying yes. And if you say yes, totoo yung ano yung sa, in sickness or in health, for richer, for poor, till death do you part. Yon, that's love. Kasi love comes from [Partner's Name]t. So, nakakahiya naman if we give it parang if we throw it away, if we don't don't use it, or na, di pa nga word na use it, if you don't nurture it, if you don't take care of it. So, di ko alam kung tama yung pag-explain ko. Pero it's a decision. It's saying yes. It's a decision of saying yes to a gift that the Lord has given you. And, in the context of marriage, yung while in church, while getting married in church, that's just the start. Pero actually the hard part is the everyday. The saying yes to the everyday. It's saying yes to the every day to that person.

Speaker: That's oo, mahilig ako sa mga light romantic movies, doc. Tsaka, ano ako avid reader ako dati ng sweet dreams and love stories nung grade 4 ako. I don't know if I ano, if same age tayo noh pero

Interviewer: I'm much older.

Speaker: You're much older? Ah, you're older than [Name]?

Interviewer: Yes, I'm the ate.

Speaker: Ah, you're the ate of [Name]. Okay, so, hindi ko alam Doc kung abutan mo yung mga sweet dreams yung mga love stories. Ayon.

Interviewer: Yung sweet dreams, yes.

Speaker: Isang araw lang, ilang oras ang nakakatapos ako na isang libro. Mahilig ako.

Interviewer: Mas sweet dreams ako more than sweet valley, Ay, sweet dreams like ps, I love you.

Speaker: Oh ayun number one. P.S., I love you. Alam ko yun. So, yun doc, hindi naman sa, na-influence ako ng mga yun, fiction yun. Pero, Theology 101 ng college, plus experiences of other people around me, my relatives, my parents, maganda rin kasi yung kwento ng parents ko siyaka parents ni [Partner's Name]. Although parents ni [Partner's Name] na sa heaven na. Parents ko, andito pa. So, sila rin yung influence namin of having a good marriage. Saying yes, deciding to say yes every day to that gift. That's my definition of love. Yun, at least na synthesize ko. That's what I wanted to say. Making that decision to say yes to that gift from the Lord. Yun, that's my definition of love. Thank you.

Interviewer: Okay

Speaker: Hindi kasi ako pwede mga mag-jump in, kaya, atsaka hahaba, kaya para- Thank you for, yeah, things like this also inspire us. Thank you.

Interviewer: Okay. So, I have, we're still on love, but if you were to gauge the importance of love in a relationship, given your definition, given your perspective of what love is, how important is that love in a relationship or how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: It is super important because what you give, the love that you give, it defines who you are. Sometimes, yung iba, they give this much lang. Some would give their whole selves. Pero ano ba dapat? Sakin, sa relationship namin, I want to give the love that [Partner's Name] deserves. And he deserves, he deserves it completely, parang fully. Kasi, parang a person kasi like him para sakin deserves that. And that will that, that love that I want to give every day can be actually manifested in so many ways. Can be simple, can be grand, although hindi ako, ayaw ko nung mga mga grand love gestures. You don't need to do those? Little things, dala ka ng pasalubong. Write a note. Mahilig ako mag write nang mga notes, mga ganyan, texts, ganyan. It can be shown kasi in the simplest ways and the simple ways naman pag kinompile mo yun, it makes it grand. So it can be shown in many ways, but ay even during kanyay the darkest days, the most pagod days, although hindi naman ako perfect wife, but I try in my own way to show how much I care, how much I appreciate. I think appreciating is also a form of love or when you sacrifice something. I think it's a form of love. Andaming forms ng love, but it depends on the situation. It depends on the context. For me kailangan i-express yun. But it can be expressed in many ways. Meron ng digital. Merong written, merong old school, merong traditional. But love should, para sa akin, it should be expressed, communicated with the other person, my husband. And it should be consistent. Consistent. Pag hindi ko nagagawa, I feel bad. Pag kunwari, sobrang pagod na ako. Hindi ko na pakita. I try to make bawi. Parang ganun. Ayon. So, I hope I answered your question.

Interviewer: Yeah, I think the first part that you said that it is the most important, I think that love is important really. And these things the way you elaborated it expression is crucial in the manifestation of that love. You mentioned other descriptions like part of it is sacrificing as well, appreciating. And of course all these things should happen in a consistent manner.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Now, last point regarding love. So, how do you know that your husband loves you? So

Speaker: Oh naku, baka abutin tayo hanggang next day. Hindi haha.

Speaker: How do I know he. Can I talk about love language?

Interviewer: Yes.

Speaker: Yung mga love language. Ang love language ng husband ko service. That's his love language. Ang love language ko doc, kaya narinig mo sa aking appreciation. Ang love language ko gifts and words. Kaya pansin mo yung sinabi ko.

Speaker: I give, I say this ganyan. Yung kasi yung love language na ibinibigay, kaya siya naman, ang love language niya para sa aking para sa mga bata, service. Ipagluluto akong niyan. Masarap siya magluto. Ipagluluto akong niyan, mamasahin yung feet ko. Nung pregnant ako dun sa second kid namin, buong nine months every day my foot massage ako. Kasi masakit yung paa ako for some reason. So he will, that's how he shows his, not just affection eh, it's really love in the form of service siya. I-wawash niya yung kotse. Small things. He will drive, mag-drive through, tapos dadalhan niya ako ng milk tea or ganun. Little simple things that he consistently shows or gives every day since [Year]. Piling ko nga sa spoiled na ako eh.

Speaker: So he also says it to me. Hindi pwede yung parang before matulog. Hindi pwede yung good night play I love you, ganon. Usually. So very consistent. Siguro pag sobrang pag-good na lang kami doc. Parang itutulog yun magkatabi kami. Hindi na namin nasasabi pero nagyayakapan na lang kami. So it's consistent kasi siya. And I would always tell him how I appreciate what he does, but he has been doing ever since.

Interviewer: Yeah, you were able to capture it clearly. Right? Now, of course, as you said earlier, wala naman perfect na relationship. So I will move on to another part of this interview which is on conflicts as well as challenges in relationship. What would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: Actually, the final question dun is do you and your partner fight? Although you said a while ago, actually part of you mentioned that you did not really have or you do not really have big fights. So maybe just a little on the idea on challenges or conflicts. What would you say even if this are not the biggest or not really what would you consider as big challenges?

Speaker: But Okay. Siguro, I'll give context muna, doc. Because we're both from the [department]. College, hawak niya. Ako ha, [department]. Sobrang busy namin. And with my work, I've been for the past [1-5] years, not including this year, [occupation] ako ng [department]. This year, I'm the [occupation] for every for all levels and I handle all [department]. So sobrang busy ko. Kaya sobrang pagod ako palagi. Now, him naman, he handles a lot din in college. He's with [department]. So, busy rin

siya at pagod. Ang pinaka kalaban namin, [Name] ay yung gusto namin, minsan mag-usap, di na kami nakaka pag-usap sa sobrang pagod at minsan late na siya nakakauwi. So it's really having that quality time. We do. We try our best. Pero minsan talaga yung pag-uwi mo gusto nilang matulong, pag-order ka lang sa [App]. Kasi sobrang pagod. I think yun yung pinaka-challenge namin right now. For the pandemic, medyo advantage yun kasi we're just at home. Pero for the past two years, hybrid learning last year, ngayon naman full face-to-face, yun ang pinaka-challenge namin.

Speaker: But prior to this year and last year, wala naman talaga kaming big challenges. Pag magkasakit ang anak namin na papraning na kami. Yun yung mga problema namin. Pero nothing like not inherent interrelationship. Parang yun na between the two of you. Kasi mag-sispring doon, doc. Sa sobrang busy, hindi siya nakasagot sa text. So maiinis ako. Or pag ako naman sobrang busy. Mag-mimesage siya. Hindi pa ako nade-detect. Oh, asa ka na naman? Sabi mo mimesage. Yun ang mga para kaming high school. Yun yung mga anu namin. Mga inis namin na parang kasi naman may meeting ako, may emergency. Ganun ng mga concerns namin, doc. Very trivial. Hindi siya wala kaming anything na yung, yung mga usually nawala kaming ganun, doc. Wala kaming ganun, doc. Ano lang it's really oh, di na tayo na pagusap. Hindi na natin na panuod. Kasi tulog na tayo. Or or ganun. Yun ang concern namin sa buhay namin. Because of amount of work and the scope of work that we have. Minsan usually during Sunday gusto namin tulog nalang kami buong araw. Pero di naman syemre pwede, kasi may mga bata. Wish lang namin. But those are our biggest challenges in our relationship. Nothing big, nothing deep, nothing against each other. Kalaban na namin time. Kasi gusto namin ng more time. Gusto namin mag-date. Gusto namin. Yun ang kalaban namin, doc.

Interviewer: Right. Okay. So thank you. All right. Thank you for that. Okay. Now, let me just go through my questions. Because yung other probe questions ko kasi, what are these fights about? How do you resolve the fights? And it seems like no big fights. And so I suppose kung meron yung example mo kanina like, halimbawa, hindi naka-replay. Ganyan. I suppose are these even resolved? Or, you know, just you just...

Speaker: Resolved naman. Kasi we try to understand each other din. So kumbaga, when you when you mention that, parang kumbaga, you just talk about it and that's settled na.

Interviewer: Parang ganoon ba yun? Okay. All right. Okay. In relation to conflict resolution, although yun nga, based on your, based on your circumstances, based on what you've said, hindi naman talaga major concern talaga yung mga big fights niyan. But in relation to maintaining the relationship, okay, what other ways, what are the other ways by which you can by which you maintain your relationship?

Speaker: Okay. We believe in family time, yung kaming apat ng mga dalawang anak namin. But we also want na meron kaming time, na kami lang na we want to date. So thank God for my parents because we dropped the kids off in their condo. And then we go out. We try to do that as often as we can

para ang trip namin ay kumain tas pumunta sa magkape. Minsan nagbabasa lang kami, hindi kami nag-uusap. Kaming dalawa lang, magkasama kami or minsan mamaya, mag-uusap na kami. Tapos mag heart to heart na kami lang ko ano-ano or magchismisan lang kami. So yung mga chismis sa school or pag may difficult situation kami sa school. Kasi siyempre na sa [department] na ko hahanapan namin ng solution. Minsan siya nagtutulong sa akin mag-write na kung anong mga guidelines and stuff sa school. So in a nutshell, we go out on dates. Para sa mga nilindate. And if it doesn't allow, wala parents ko and wala kami choice, we go on a date downstairs.

Speaker: Kasi I'm currently in our bedroom and dun sa dining area, ang gagawan namin, sasabihin namin, sa mga anak namin o dyan lang kayo sa ano, sa bedroom kami sa baba, mag-didate kami. Tapos timpla lang kami ng kape. Tapos ka-kakain kami ng cake. Yun na yung date namin if we couldn't go out. So it has been going on for a long time na. We do that. We go on dates to keep the relationship kasi corny naman kong kung hindi mo gawan ng paraan. So we try to, we try to travel also pero ano na yun eh, travel na pang we can't leave the kids. So we try to just mga masin yung family. Pag-travel. Pag-travel, kasama talagay mong, kasi [1-5]-year-old yung maliit. And then [11-15] pa lang yung panganay. So hirap din iwan. Ayaw din namin iwan sila kung magkunyari mag-abroad kami. But we want that sana. Pero right now, parang hirap pa-iwan ng mga bata. So we bring them along. We just came from [Location] nung [Date] ganoon. So pero dala namin yung mga anak namin. So but I think yung looking forward to those dates, I think that keeps the relationship still exciting.

Interviewer: Right. Thank you. Alright. Alright. So this one, would you say that the relationship is good for you? And why?

Speaker: Yes. Yes. Yun lang, yes. And I think everything that I've mentioned a while ago is already, I mean, that will support my answer, which is a yes.

Interviewer: Alright. This question kasi has something to do with being able to achieve your goals, your day-to-day functioning because of your relationship with your partner. So yun yung idea nung question na, would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Yes. Definitely. Alright.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you. Now, the next part is on your identity. So did this relationship change you? And in what way, if yes?

Speaker: It changed me for the better. Yes. Before, akala ko, ito lang yung pwede kong ma-reach as a [occupation]. [Occupation] kasi ako to cross in. If this is, parang ang dito lang ako, but actually through my husband, I get to do what what I really want to achieve in my career. In fact, parang maslalalong bumulusok yung career ko when I met my husband. He would encourage me to pursue my goals. So from being a [occupation], kasi [occupation] ako na sa [location] ako when I met him, then I became a [occupation], then I became [occupation] and now I'm [occupation]. So and yun lang siya in my climbing, the ladder of success. Ano siya instrumental siya in the success that I have?

Interviewer: Alright. How about your partner? Did they change? I mean, your husband particularly nagbago ba siya during the relationship? Did he change during the relationship from your perspective?

Interviewer: I think yes, but it's introverted kasi siya, introvert siya. But parang and atsaka sorry, introvert siya by nature, but he is more expressive of his feelings, of his, he speaks his mind now more often compared to before. Sa akin, kasi pinipili, lang niya kung kanino siya mag-open up. And sa akin, parang almost automatic pag meron siya parang and hindi ko na siya technically napansin, parang mas mas lalong ano siya. Ako kasi ang extrovert sa aming dalawa. Extrovert. So, I think nag-complement talaga kami when it comes to that noh. And he's more expressive. It's okay kung ibig sabihin na parang it's okay to cry if you feel bad and he doesn't mind to be in tears pag meron talagang nakakapag-upset sa kanya. Kasi siya hindi naman ibig sabihin nun na hindi ka lalaki. Ibig sabihin tao. Ganon.

Interviewer: And this became more, is that correct? This is a bit more, became more prominent when you're together, when you started being together.

Speaker: Yes. So, chaka, dun ko na realize how much he trusts me. Kasi he didn't say these things if he didn't trust me, if he wouldn't open up ganyan. So, I think the relationship or how we are as a married couple parang has helped him also. I think yun yung a good change that I saw in him.

Interviewer: Okay. Okay. Next question. Thank you for that. Do you feel safe in the relationship? So, concept naman ng safety and maybe if you can make a more concrete example or just elaborate on this. So you said, yes, why do you say so?

Speaker: Okay. May concept kasi of feeling and being safe is that you are free to to express, you are free to do things, tapos at the same time, if there is anything hindi maganda sa environment, kunwari may hindi magandang nangyari in all, he's going to be the first one to protect me. Parang ganun na yung notion ko of safety, na parang hindi ako natatakot, kasi nandyan siya. Ano to, figuratively and literally speaking, he's there, so why will I be afraid of anything? And again, I mentioned it earlier, something about living in fear. I don't live in fear of anything, kasi alam ko nandyan siya. Parang di ba, those who live in fear is hiding something or is not okay with themselves or is not okay with whoever in the household, if you live in fear, ano yun may kasalanan, so parang being safe, I can tell him anything because I trust him and I know no harm will come my way parang ganon, if he can control it, wala mga wala talaga because he's there. He's going to be the first person who will protect me and my children. So to answer you in other words, yes, I feel very safe with him.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you. Now, I will be showing some slides because the next question will require a visual.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: let's find that file. Okay. All right, here, this one particularly. All right. So I have, actually have these are just two questions. So as you can see on this slide, my partner so he'll just answer from not at all true to completely true so that's from from a range of one to nine. So kindly just respond to that question. My partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker: Do I say the number or the equivalent?

Interviewer: Yeah, it could be the number or the quality okay din.

Speaker: Okay. Okay.

Interviewer: Because sometimes baka eight ang sagot mo so walang katumbas pero it's between based on the number negative descriptions.

Speaker: yeah. Okay. My answer to this is a nine.

Interviewer: A nine. All right. Okay, so wait. All right, now I'll just show first the next slide and then para stop share ko siya. This is the next question. What about if I were to ask you this next question. My partner usually is responsive to my needs. So from not at all true to completely true as well from a range of one to nine.

Speaker: A nine doc..

Interviewer: All right. Okay. All right. I'll stop share. There's one more item later that I need this but I'll stop share muna. So just a follow up question. I hope you can still remember and then stop share na. For the first question, the question was on whether let me just say the sentence. My partner usually really listens to me. So, and you answered nine. If I'm correctly remembering it. So your answer is nine for item number one. Can you give a concrete example of let's say when this happened and like if you said nine, why not eight? For example, because nine sagad na yon na, but why not eight? For example,

Speaker: Yeah. Okay. My answer is nine because...

Interviewer: Maybe I'll show it again.

Speaker: Or even before we got married, between the two of us kasi ako yung mas expressive, ako yung mas nagsasabi ng mga saloobin, especially when it comes to work. And I'm just super blessed na he is a listener talaga yung husband ko. And when he listens, he will ask me if do you want me to say anything or you just want me to listen to you. Or do you want me to give you a solution or to lead you to a solution? May may ganun pa. May ganun pa siya. May ganun pa siya. Minsan kasi gusto ko, mag-rant lang ako. Tas' okay na ako. Or minsan naman gusto ko, tulungan mo ko, kailangan ko ng solution. Lalo na mostly it's really work-related. So consistent since especially when we got married kasi magkasama na kami day and night. So, he would really listen to me. And I guess patagal kami na patagal, eh syempre, mas mataas na yung position ko ngayon sa school. So mas marami na siyang narinig na kwento at mga rants from me. And ganun pa rin siya. Napaka-consistent. Makikining lang siya? Ngayon nga lang, sasabihin muna niya, "Oh ano, magbibigay ba ako ng solution?" "Anong gusto mo", ganyan. Kasi minsan nga, you just want to be listened to. So that's why it's a nine. Kasi consistent siya, doc. Ever since. He's just a kind of person. Or in the keyword that you were, you know, how you elaborated on it is, I think what's important there is yun nga. He's a true listener and the idea that it's consistent.

Interviewer: Right? You were saying that it's consistent yung pag listen nga. Right?

Interviewer: Now for item number two, the question or the item talks about my partner is usually is responsive to my needs. And for that item, you also answered nine. So the same question, why did you answer nine for item two? Why not again, eight, you know? Which is also high, of course, but of course you answered nine. So if you can also elaborate on that.

Speaker: Okay. Since we got together in [Year], he would really pay attention to my needs, whether it's emotional, emotional, spiritual, physical, kasi minamasahe niya ako, physical or even financial. So wala akong masabi. He has been responding to what I need, whether I just want him to listen to my problems or I want especially when I was pregnant, the two times, and I also had a miscarriage kasi before our second child, I got pregnant, pero nagkamiscarriage ako, grabe yung grabe yung ginawan niyang pag-aalaga sa akin noon, kasi I blame myself. Although 11 weeks pa lang naman yung baby, I lost, we lost the baby because natural reasons, di na siya nabuo. So nagspotting ako and then na wala na yung baby. So yun yung naalala kong moment na talagang siguro kong ibang lalaki yun, mapipikon na yun sa akin, kasi I was self-blaming me. And then also, doc, when our first born, when our first child was born, I got PTD, pulmonary tuberculosis. I got really sick, that was the worst. So grabe rin yung pag-aalaga nya sa akin noon, in all aspects. Emotional, mental, physical, everything na. So and then others are work-related na. So yun yung mga health-related, but after that, again, I will use the word consistent. He has been very consistent. Ultimo, doc, favorite ko kasi ang [Brand] na, kasi alam mo ba yung [Brand] na chocolate. Lagi akong lagi akong may baon noon. Hindi pa kami kasal, pag nagkita kami ng weekend, lagi akong may

baon na yun yun. So may tatlong piraso for the week. Ganun, ganun siya ka, hindi ko hinihingi, bibigay niya, kahit hindi ko hinihingi.

Speaker: And hanggang ngayon, ganun siya. Ganun parin siya. Ganun parin siya. Yung magugulat ka na lang, okay, may milk tea na ako kasi alam niyang gusto ko yun. At alam niyang kailangan ko yun ngayon, parang, para di hindi ako ma, para ma cheer up ako, kunyari ay I am having a very tiring, I was having a very tiring day. He knows, sometimes, mas alam pa nga niya na kailangan ko yung mga bagay niyang kaysa sa sarili ko. So the littlest things, or even the big things, he gives it, without asking for anything in return. And he gives it generously. And he has been like that ever since. And alam ko na kung bakit siya ganun sa akin. Kasi, ganun din yung parents niya sa kanya, ganun siya pinalaki. And that's how he also, that's how he is to everyone around him. Swerte lang ako kasi ako yung, ako yung recipient sa araw-araw, pati yung mga anak namin. He gives without asking for anything in return. And he is giving, he is still giving, until now. That's what, that's one of the things I love about my husband.

Speaker: Kaya nine. Kahit may rubric pa yan, doc. Kahit may rubric, nine parin ang makukuha niya.

Interviewer: Tama. Oo nga no, parang rubric, no?

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: Thank you for that. Actually medyo malapit-lapit na tayo matapos, kaya lang I have to ask this question. It has some people to do with, you qualified earlier that your needs are being addressed, and it was quite holistic when you enumerated these dimensions where your needs are being addressed. But at the same time of course in any relationship or even of course in marriage, there's physical intimacy. And of course there's sex, for example. So I hope you don't mind if I ask and feel free to say if this is too sensitive. I'm using a script. This is too sensitive for you to share. But I also want to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. Of course whatever you're willing to share.

Speaker: Wala rin akong, wala akong reklamo. Kasi when you say physical intimacy, it doesn't just refer to sex. It refers to your closeness or how much you want to be close to the person physically. Hugs, kisses. It's not really just about sex. Pero wala akong, nine pa rin siya doc kung may scale.

Interviewer: Kung may rating man.

Speaker: Nine pa rin kasi ano tawag dito. It's part of any marriage. And if that part is not, quote-unquote fulfilled or kung walang ganon, there's something wrong with the marriage. Diba?

Interviewer: Oo

Speaker: I think it's also like what I mentioned earlier, it's also a form of love. Kasi asawa mo yan eh. You trust that person. You give yourself to the person. Ako wala akong, I'm not ashamed to say na there is definitely nothing wrong but it means I have no nothing bad to say. I-rate na lang natin doc.

Interviewer: Wala naman rating. Wala naman rating. Actually mas you just about in a relationship physical intimacy and satisfaction actually. Although part of that is of course you already answered. That's the follow-up question. Like how satisfied are you with your sex life and why do you say so and something like that.

Speaker: Kasi you make time for that because it's important. It's a it's part of the marriage. It's something that you also want to express. Wala, bakit ka mahihiya mag-express eh asawa mo yun

parang hindi ba deserve niya yun yun. Yung sa akin, and minsan nga Doc magkaatulog na lang kami na magkayakap kami. Hanggang ngayon sa parang sobrang pagod kayakap na lang kami. Tapos under the blanket kasi nga yun naka aircon. Makatulog lang ganon. For me that's already intimacy and for me it makes the marriage stronger you trust your husband you trust each other enough to express it in that way kasi that's a form of love. So siguro Doc ang challenge parati kami pagod. Gustuhin man namin, I guess yun nang siguro challenge kasi sometimes you would like to sleep na lang sa sobrang pagod but ofcourse we make time for that.

Interviewer: Okay. So thank you for that. Now last I think this is the last question and then I'll just talk about the data yung preference the one I was talking about earlier I have to flash another slide let me share this. So actually this wait this one parang nagsagot mo na I have to go through this as well it's more on your overall satisfaction about your relationship so to ask the question in general how satisfied are you with your relationship? So as you can see there are choices there completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied up to of course completely satisfied so which one will you choose based on the choices that we have?

Speaker: I'm there Doc sa completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Right.

Interviewer: So if you answered completely satisfied okay let me just show you another slide let me make sure that this is the right one, so your answer is completely satisfied, I think this one. So, since you answered completely satisfied or completely satisfied actually poede yan or very satisfied this particular slide, I want you to choose from the scale again if zero is not at all satisfied, and 10 was completely satisfied or is completely satisfied how would you now rate your satisfaction with your relationship. So that's from zero to 10?

Speaker: it's a 10, Doc .

Interviewer: 10 right. Okay so now as a follow up question to this. Why did you answer 10 ayan. Again just like the question earlier, why not for example it's 10 but why not 9 or something nearer to 10

Speaker: Okay, while I know that there are many or there are still areas for improvement when it comes to the relationship kasi wala naman perfect pero kasi hindi ko habol ang perfection. So ang sa akin the relationship in itself is already a blessing. For me, I'm already completely satisfied na ang asawa ko si [Partner's Name], he might not be the perfect kasi wala naman perfect na tao he might not be the perfect husband but he has been a wonderful husband to me yun pa lang blessing na yun and I'm saying this not just because I'm comparing it to the I mean my friends who are not satisfied with their husbands or their relationships or marriages I'm not saying that na may comparison but kung titingan ko maswerte talaga ako sa asawa ko, ah I am naturally a happy person and I am happier because of him. I get to do, I am successful in my career because of him. I have happy marriage, a happy home with my children because of him. So, ano pang hahanapin ko? Wala na ako hinahanap, wala na ako hinahanap. Ang lagi ko lang dasal is good health, safety, protection namin but with the relationship gusto ko pang mag- travel with him gusto ko pang ganito ganyan-ganyan but as it is, I am completely satisfied [Name]

Interviewer: Yes, thank you so much actually that's the final question before I go to the data notice of course I will not go through all the details that you said but I'll just go through my notes and then I'll just highlight the things that you've shared with me tonight, like for example right, so I think in terms of

relationship quality, you did mention that a healthy relationship I think when I ask you to compare your relationship with the relationships of your let's say friends, you mentioned something about stability, the importance of trust, and friendship you also mentioned very specific if you think about strategies the communication is healthy it's constant and then there's understanding and they're selfless. The relationship is characterized being selfless but at the same time you also said something about having your own thing so you're together and yet you are able to keep your identity separate. And then you also mentioned something about the importance of comparison to other relationships, you noticed that of course this particular relationship is really more mature compared to previous relationships. And narrowing down, let's say a high quality from a low quality comparing the two, you mentioned that the high quality relationship started right kasi so it's one of the indicators of a high quality relationship. There's also the affirmation of people you love and of course you reiterate, emphasize this also the importance of faith in the Lord and the Lord being the center of your relationship which you said that is actually the most important factor in the relationship. And then we discussed something about love and you said that love is not really just a feeling but it is a decision that you make every day, sabi mo nga you say yes to love every day and love as a gift and then if there's anything that has posed some challenge to your relationship it's because yung nga, yung pagiging busy niyo sa relasyon, I mean sa work. And therefore sa relationship madalas napapagod, kumbaga, if may wish ka or something like that at your relationship is to really spend more time together but your work circumstances, of course may certainly demand siya sa inyong dalawa and therefore yun yung nakita mo siguro na challenges but no major fights and therefore no major conflicts but in terms of relationship maintenance you did mention that it's important to make time for the family as well as of course make time for the two of you and that's where you mentioned something on dates to keep the relationship exciting. And then in terms of identity you did mention that in terms of your identity yung key word mo dito is you became a better person. And, in the same way your husband also became more expressive and has been more open especially to you and you see that as a manifestation of his trust. And with respect to feeling safe, you said that yes you feel safe in the relationship, there's no, it's not about living in fear but you see that you're safe with your husband that he will protect you and at the same time I think related dito kanina when you said being safe, safe in terms of you're really open, the openness in your relasyon na hindi ka natatakot sabihin yung nararamdaman mo sa kaniya. And then of course, you answered nine, doon sa mga questions natin kanina and yung key word mo dun is why you answered that is because consistent and then andun yung idea ng pagiging holistic din ng pag-address niya sa mga needs mo. And with respect to physical intimacy and sex for example, you noted that this is important in any relationship and that you make time for it. Although you did mention that in some situations where you are already tired physical intimacy is of course not just limited to the actual sex act or the sex act itself but also includes other forms of physical intimacy like hugging.

Interviewer: And then and in general kumbaga mag-overall satisfaction with the relationship, you did mention that you are completely satisfied. And I noted here that you are actually happier because of him to qualify the answer. So I hope I was able to capture the most important or at least your points.

Speaker: Yes you did, yes you did.

Interviewer: I will stop share pala muna and so now okay thank you so much for sharing, You know it's so inspiring to listen to you and I know that more than one hour na tayo but it's about 40 minutes but I mean more than it's more than an hour pero pag nag exceed ng like 15 minutes. For the data notice, again before we end, I'll just read my notes here. Let's talk about how we will handle the data so as a

research project if you see in the consent form of course meron na dung kung saan siya ishi- share kasi ganyan din na ngayon meron tayong open science kung saan nilalagay actually dun yung data so if this becomes a transcription the transcription will be made available in the open science portal, but of course, anonymize siya, ibig sabihin nun ay, walang identity leading back to you. So we want to be ethically transparent as possible and so we want to know which data sharing option you are most comfortable with. So option one is that transcript portions can be shared none of which can be identified to you so that the identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. Okay.

Interviewer: And then option two is actually the encodes the more bolder one because basically the whole transcript including our you know will be transcribed and can be shared but of course definitely removed of sensitive and overly identifying details like the ones you mentioned where your workplace like the address for example those should be removed, those should be redacted like Bacoor ganun or

Speaker: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: Those will be removed, but basically the answer to your questions will be retained but any identifying marks usually nireduct naman natin sa research. Names, even age perhaps and even addresses and the workplace anything that's really more personal to you will be removed. So those are the two options so of the two options which one are you comfortable with?

Speaker: Okay...okay....kasi um, I do research also doc if there's anonymity naman and wala siyang any, anything reference to me I don't mind sharing the whole thing.

Interviewer: Okay, alright.

Speaker: Because it might help others because wala akong tinatago sa lahat ng sinagot ko sayo. Just the, just may anonymity naman siya so which option is that, doc?

Interviewer: Option 2 wherein kumbaga there'll be a transcription of what transpired today so basically this recording I will be sending this to the lead person si Miguel, si Lan yung yung name doon and kumbaga doon sa aming files, andun na yung mga recordings pero ang transcription kasi. Syempre, hindi na ako yung magtatranscribe sila na yung magtatranscribe.

Speaker: Ah okay for as long as ano naman anonymous naman doc. I don't mind kasi because I think what I shared it might be helpful to to I believe in generously, ano tawag dito yung pag nag-disseminate ng research findings. I believe in that eh. Atsaka, wala, there's nothing in what I said that parang kailangan itago ko, wala eh, I mean it's for sharing. Just the ano, if it remains anonymous, I don't mind option 2.

Interviewer: of course the names, all of this, we will follow that. So that's option 2 si I will note it nalang here na option 2. That's, and then they'll also hear naman in the recording. What I can also do is but diba via zoom we can also just share the audio. Would you prefer that?

Speaker: Yeah, oo.

Interviewer: We can also do that so when I share let's say when I download the recording, I can just share the audio, they know naman the slides nagsasalita naman ako so that's okay I think right.

Speaker: Hala maririnig nila yung [inaudible] about kay kathiel. Joke.

Interviewer: Okay lang yun. So thank you so actually that ends this particular session thank you so much for participating in this setting.

Speaker: Thank you also, I should call you [Name] de' joke lang,

Interviewer: Si [Name], she calls me, may nickname ako sa kaniya so she really doesn't call me ate.

Speaker: I should call you ate.

Interviewer: Meron kaming ano tawag mo doon yung parang nacondensed version ng ate. So, so before we end this interview, I mentioned earlier yung mechanism kasi ng pag-recruit is a bit complicated. SO if you can, I will just send you an email again with respect to this if you can recommend two close people in your life as nominators not as a participant in the study but as nominators who might know other couples in the study. So maybe two doon which means one from let's say from your end and then one from [Partner's Name] later. And, so these people will contact and then hopefully meron din silang couples na marecommend, so sila you will nominate and then these nominees will I will reach out to them but I will need of course some heads up from you para they will not block me kasi baka sabihin nila scam lang ako or something. Baka kasi syempre uso ngayon may mag-message tayo so baka spam mail or nagsascam sa messenger or something like that. But I can just re-send an email with this given this particular request

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: And there's another email that I will also send, yung meron kasi doon parang survey later but maybe that can come later after the interview with [Partner's Name]. So do you want to interview [Partner's Name] now or do you want another time akala ko kasi kanina Doc sabay kami iinterview. Ang gusto kasi, i-off ko lang yung recording, pause ko lang...